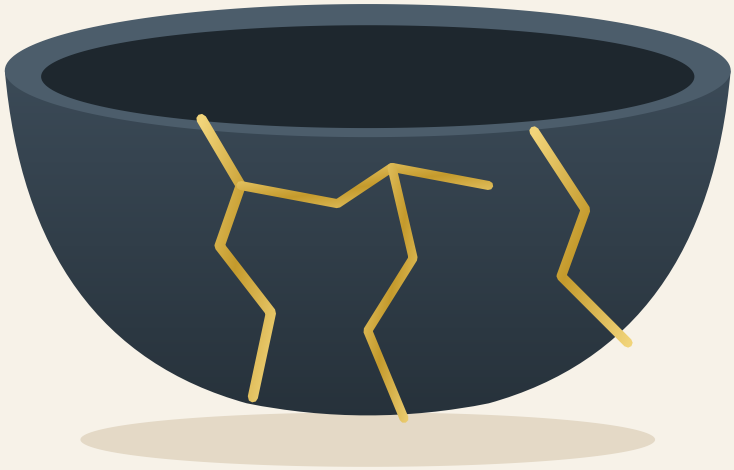
META VR START DEVELOPER COMPETITION 2026



Mend

Every crack has a story.

A short overview of the competition, our project and our team,
prepared for the person kindly considering lending us a Meta Quest 3.

Ahammad Shawki and Mohammad Ashfaqul Hasan
CSE, Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology (BUET) | October 2026

1. THE COMPETITION

A $1 million competition run by Meta

The Meta VR Start Developer Competition 2026 invites developers worldwide to build new apps for Meta Quest headsets that are controlled with your hands, not controllers. It is hosted on Devpost, the platform behind most major online hackathons.

$1M
total prize pool across all tracks and awards

$100k
for the winner of our track (Entertainment, New), $50k for the runner-up

Nov 18
submission deadline. Winners announced around Dec 11, 2026

What the judges look for

- **Innovation:** an original idea that uses the headset's unique features
- **Experience design:** easy from the first second, with a reason to come back
- **Technical quality:** smooth, bug-free, uses hands and mixed reality well
- **Polish:** beautiful art, sound and a clear demo video

Why a real Quest 3 matters

The judges test every entry on a **Meta Quest 3 or Quest 3S**. We can build most of the app in a desktop simulator, but only a real headset tells us:

- how picking up objects with your hands actually feels
- whether it runs smoothly (at least 60 frames per second)
- how it looks in colour on a real table
- and lets us record real footage for our video

Extra awards we are aiming for ($25k each)

Best First Five Minutes · Reason to Come Back · Boldest Original Concept · Accessibility Forward · Judge's Choice ($20k)

Source: start-developer-competition-26.devpost.com

2. OUR PROJECT

Mend: put a family's broken keepsakes back together, with your hands

> *"Your grandmother has left you a box of broken things. Each one broke at a turning point in her family's life."*

When you put on the headset, a small wooden box appears on **your real table**. Inside are the pieces of a broken tea cup. You pick them up with your bare hands, turn them, and fit them together. Every piece that clicks into place plays a short memory, spoken from inside the cup.

When the cup is whole, you trace its cracks with your fingertip and liquid gold follows, inspired by **kintsugi**, the Japanese art of repairing pottery with gold. The mended cup goes on a shelf that **stays in your room**, and a new keepsake waits for you the next day.



Open the box
It appears on your real table

Fit the pieces
Pick up, turn and click them in

Hear a memory
The voice comes from the object

Trace the gold
Your fingertip fills the cracks

Keep it
A shelf that stays in your room

Seven keepsakes, one family

A tea cup, a clay bird, a dinner plate, a teapot, a vase, a child's bowl and, finally, the grandmother's own rice bowl. Together they tell the story of three generations. The last bowl has no voice: it waits for a memory of your own.

Why it only works in VR

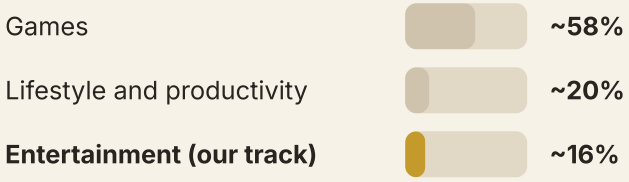
- You hold and turn real-feeling pieces with your hands
- It happens on your own table, in your own room
- The shelf is still there tomorrow
- Memories come from the object itself, in 3D sound

3. WHY WE THINK WE CAN WIN

We studied all 653 entries from last year before choosing

We collected every project from last year's competition and their 32 winners, then tested more than ten ideas against the judging rules before settling on Mend.

Last year's entries by type



Entertainment pays the same top prize as Games ($100k) with roughly a quarter of the competition.

What we found

- Winners had **one magical hand interaction** at their core. Ours: fitting pieces and tracing gold.
- Only about **10 of 653** entries were emotional stories. Very few people build this kind of experience.
- No public VR app does kintsugi with family stories, mixed reality and a shelf that stays in your room.
- Crowded themes (shooters, fitness, meditation, music) are exactly what we avoided.

Our own scorecard (out of 10, honest self-assessment)



What the Quest 3 changes

Last year, an average entry had about a **1 in 20** chance of winning a prize (32 winners out of 653). With a Quest 3 for testing and filming, we estimate Mend's chance of winning a prize at roughly **1 in 5**, about four times the average. It is not guaranteed, but it is a real shot, and the headset is the single biggest thing that moves the odds.

Estimates are our own, based on last year's public results.

4. WHO WE ARE

Two BUET CSE students who build and win hackathons

We take part in international hackathons regularly, usually online on Devpost, and we have won several of them together and separately. Our work is public on GitHub and Devpost.

AS

Ahammad Shawki | team lead

CSE undergraduate at BUET. Over 6 years of open-source development. Works on AI agents, full-stack apps, testing and model evaluation.

- **Grand Prize**, FLIR App Challenge 2025 to 2026 (SolarSnap)
- **Best Overall Project**, ML Empowerment Build Challenge 2.0 (CADENCE, Parkinson's voice screening)
- **Winner**, ERNIE AI Developer Challenge by Baidu (Doclyst)
- **Winner**, Agents for Humans Hackathon (Shoulder)
- **Honourable mention and finalist**, LMA EDGE Hackathon, presented in London (Coven)

ahammadshawki8.github.io | github.com/ahammadshawki8 | devpost.com/ahammadshawki8 | linkedin.com/in/ahammadshawki8

AH

Mohammad Ashfaqul Hasan | developer

CSE undergraduate at BUET. Builds AI agents, mobile apps and games (including Godot projects).

- **Winner**, Agents for Humans Hackathon, Everyday Agents and Golden Agent (Shoulder)
- **Winner**, ERNIE AI Developer Challenge by Baidu (Doclyst)
- **Winning team**, Storyblok x Code and Coffee Hackathon 2025 (GameBlok)

github.com/ashfaqstu | devpost.com/ashfaqstu

6+
international hackathon wins between us

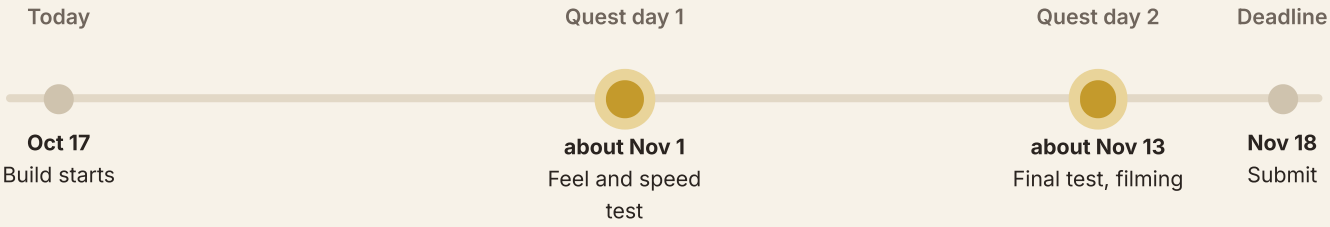
20+
hackathon projects on Devpost

Public
our projects are on GitHub and Devpost for you to check

5. WHAT WE ARE ASKING FOR

A Quest 3 for 1 to 2 days, treated with care

We will build everything we can in the simulator first, so every hour with the headset counts. Ideally we would borrow it on two short occasions; one 2-day block also works.



Our promise for the headset

- Kept in its case, lenses covered and away from sunlight
- Used only by the two of us, indoors, at a desk
- Returned on time, clean and fully charged
- We can meet in person and sign a simple written note with our names and contact details
- If anything is damaged while with us, we take responsibility

What you get

- Your name in the project credits (if you want)
- Early access to try Mend yourself
- The option to **join the team**, with a share of any prize money agreed in writing beforehand
- Or a rental fee for the 2 days, if you prefer that

Thank you for considering it.

Questions are very welcome. Reply in our message thread, or reach us through the profiles on the previous page.
Follow the project at github.com/ahammadshawki8/mend

Ahammad Shawki and Mohammad Ashfaqul Hasan, BUET CSE